



Experts' Opinion

Security experts offer an insight into what can be done to ensure greater safety

PRAKASH SINGH



Former DG, BSF

- Immediate filling up of vacancies in the police force.
- Stop using the police force to protect criminal-politicians.
- SWAT teams should be set up for metros.
- Effective control rooms to ensure a three-minute response time.

JULIO RIBEIRO



Former DGP, Punjab

- Leaders should be selected from a list of empanelled officers
- Give operational freedom to senior officers.
- Investigation agency should be separate from law and order machinery.
- Public participation in policing.

BRIG B.K. PONWAR



Director, CTJWS, Kanker

- Policemen have to be combatised.
- Train them in reflex shooting for a counter-terrorism environment.
- Replace old rifles with modern carbines like MP-5.
- Improve leadership at ASI, SI and SP level.

AJAY SAHNI



ED, Centre for Conflict Studies

- Invest in policing as a planned outlay.
- Utilise existing capacities more efficiently by retraining.
- Bring police-population ratios in line with required norms.
- Establish intelligence capacities within the State Police.

be linked with other armed forces, intelligence agencies and receive feeds from CCTVs all across the city. These control rooms need to be manned round-the-clock by young, ranking and energetic officers with rapid decision-making ability. These control rooms should have large Google Earth-like digital map projections of the city and a fleet of fast cars capable of reaching any trouble spot within five minutes.

Trained and heavily armed

Special Weapons and Tactics (SWAT) teams of around 100 personnel with special weapons, communication devices, armoured vehicles and helicopters should be immediately raised in all the major metros to ensure quick reaction teams for 24x7 emergencies. New technology like facial recognition software and day-night CCTV cameras needs to be embraced.

For the police forces, buying communication equipment and weaponry off-the-shelf is only one part of the challenge—cut-

ting through bureaucratic red tape to spend money in time will be a greater one.

Training a policeman to use modern weapons is another challenge because an untrained policeman armed with a sophisticated Heckler and Koch MP-5 sub-machine gun is as good as unarmed. Another measure would be to guard major landmarks and practice counter-terrorism drills there. Digital blueprints of all major landmarks including hotels, IT parks, malls and large offices must be kept by the police to help plan for eventualities like hostage situations. Policemen must also be trained to act as negotiators in a crisis situation.

Intelligence branches need to be staffed with career officers. There's a need to create intelligence analysis units dedicated to analysing inputs received from state and central intelligence agencies. Not being proactive on policing will mean an invitation to terrorists to strike at our engines of growth.

Action Plan

CONTROL rooms manned round-the-clock by energetic officers.

SWAT teams of 100 men in each city capable of withstanding and repelling heavy assaults, hostage situations and building intervention.

INCREASE in manpower. Filling up of all vacant posts. Reviving beat policing.

POLICEMEN to be trained in on-ground operational exercises for high building interventions in various locations like malls, multiplexes and hotels.

BETTER training for all personnel. Frequent access to police firing ranges.

REORIENTATION of the policeman—from a FIR-based post-crime approach to a pro-active initiative-based approach.